



Kuppam Johari

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[TryHackMe](#) | [HackTheBox](#) | [Medium CTF Write-ups](#) | [NIST](#) [CVE-2025-4863](#)

Professional Summary

Offensive Security Specialist with hands-on expertise in **Vulnerability Assessment & Penetration Testing (VAPT)**, web application security, network security, and exploit development. Proficient in end-to-end penetration testing engagements covering reconnaissance, exploitation, post-exploitation, and professional reporting aligned with **OWASP Top 10**, **PTES**, and **MITRE ATT&CK**.

Notable achievements include the discovery of **CVE-2025-4863** (critical SQL injection in a production ERP system), an **IEEE-published** security research paper on automated web application security, and **Ethical Hacking training delivered to 400+ Indian Armed Forces officers and 1000+ college students**. Experienced in translating technical findings into actionable risk reports for both executive and engineering audiences.

Core Competencies

Penetration Testing	Web App Pentesting, Network Pentesting, API Security Testing, Mobile App Testing (Android), Red Team Simulation, Social Engineering, Post-Exploitation
Web App Security	OWASP Top 10, SQL Injection, XSS, IDOR, SSRF, Broken Access Control, CSRF, XXE, Insecure Deserialization, Business Logic Flaws
Vulnerability Assessment	Network Scanning, Service Enumeration, CVE Research, Risk Scoring (CVSS), Patch Gap Analysis, Remediation Advisory
Exploitation & Tools	Burp Suite Pro, Metasploit, SQLmap, Nmap, Nessus, OpenVAS, Acunetix, Nikto, Gobuster, Hydra, Wireshark
Security Operations	SIEM (Splunk, QRadar), Incident Triage, Log Analysis, SOC Alerts and Escalation, Detection Rule Tuning
Reporting & Compliance	VAPT Report Writing, Executive Risk Summaries, CVSS Scoring, OWASP, NIST 800-115, ISO 27001 Control Mapping

Professional Experience

Askeal Jan 2026 – Present
Beta Tester – AI Cybersecurity Assistant Remote

- Evaluated AI-driven cybersecurity workflows by simulating real-world attack scenarios including injection attacks, bypass techniques, and adversarial prompt abuse against detection pipelines.
- Identified capability gaps and edge-case failures in threat detection logic; provided structured offensive-perspective feedback directly informing product roadmap improvements.

Freelancer Mar 2024 – Present
Freelance Cyber Security Consultant Bangalore & Hyderabad, India

Delivered offensive security engagements for EdTech platforms, ERP systems, and SaaS startups, including full-scope web application and network penetration tests, vulnerability assessments, and security awareness training for 1400+ individuals.

Penetration Testing & VAPT Engagements:

- Conducted black-box and grey-box web application penetration tests for 30+ client environments; identified and exploited critical vulnerabilities including **SQL Injection (CVE-2025-4863)**, IDOR, Broken Access Control, and Insecure Direct Object References in production ERP and SaaS systems.
- Mapped all findings to **OWASP Top 10** and **MITRE ATT&CK** techniques; produced professional pentesting reports with executive summaries, technical deep-dives, and step-by-step remediation guidance.

- Conducted network-level vulnerability assessments using Nessus and OpenVAS; identified unpatched CVEs, misconfigured services, and lateral movement paths.
- Delivered ethical hacking and VAPT methodology training covering web exploitation, network scanning, and responsible disclosure to **400+ Indian Armed Force officers** and **1000+ college students**.

Impact & Outcomes:

- Responsibly disclosed **CVE-2025-4863** (Critical – CVSS 9.8), a SQL injection vulnerability in a live ERP platform, preventing potential data breach and unauthorized administrative access.
- Reduced critical and high-severity vulnerability exposure across client environments through structured remediation planning with clear ownership and timelines.

Ramanasoft
Cyber Security Analyst

2024 – 2025
Hyderabad, India

- Monitored and analyzed security events using Splunk and QRadar; triaged IDS/IPS and SIEM alerts, correlated logs for attack pattern identification, and escalated confirmed incidents per defined playbooks.
- Supported internal vulnerability assessment cycles – scanned assets with Nessus, tracked CVE exposure, and contributed to remediation prioritization.
- Assisted in threat analysis and mapped incident indicators to MITRE ATT&CK TTPs, supporting detection rule improvements and reducing false positive rates.

Key Projects

Enterprise SOC & VAPT Simulation Lab
Built a simulated enterprise lab with SIEM (Splunk & Wazuh), IDS/IPS (Snort), and Wazuh. Simulated real-world attacks (OWASP Top 10, privilege escalation, lateral movement, persistence), mapped to MITRE ATT&CK, and created custom detection rules to reduce alert fatigue. Used the lab for hands-on offensive and defensive training.

Nov 2025 – Jan 2026

Automated Web Application Hacking Framework
Designed and built an automated penetration testing framework targeting OWASP Top 10 vulnerability classes in web applications. The tool automated reconnaissance (subdomain enumeration, directory brute-forcing), active scanning (SQLi, XSS, IDOR detection), and exploit chaining using Python and Burp Suite API integrations. Reduced manual testing time by automating high-frequency attack patterns. Research based on this framework was accepted and published at [IEEE ICCDS 2024](#).

Jan 2024 – Apr 2024

Publications & CVEs

CVE-2025-4863	Critical SQL Injection - Production ERP System nvd.nist.gov/vuln/detail/CVE-2025-4863
IEEE 2024	<i>Automated Web Application Security Framework</i> - ICCDS 2024 ieeexplore.ieee.org/document/10560380

Education

B.Tech in Computer Science & Engineering (Cyber Security)
Madanapalle Institute of Technology & Science

2020 - 2024
CGPA: 8.27 / 10

Certifications

- Acknowledgement Letter from INDIAN NAVY
 - GitHub Foundations
 - MCE: Microsoft Certified Educator
 - Microsoft 365 Certified: Fundamentals
 - Certified Network Security Practitioner (CNSP)
 - Certified Ethical Hacker - CEH (Trained)
 - Microsoft Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900)
 - Microsoft Security Fundamentals (SC-900)
 - Letter of Appreciation (Madanapalle Institution of Technology & Science)